Shourya Sen

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

Princeton University, Princeton, NJ 2027
Ph.D., Political Science, (expected 2027)
M.A., Political Science (2022, incidental degree)
Exam Fields: Comparative Politics, Formal Theory & Quantitative Methods
Other areas of focus: Political economy, Southeast Asia
Committee: Carles Boix (chair), Leonard Wantchekon, Rory Truex, Germán Gieczewski

Wesleyan University, Middletown, CT 2015
B.A. (with honors), Economics
Phi Beta Kappa Honors Society (2015)

University of Oxford, Lady Margaret Hall, Oxford, UK 2013-2014
Visiting Student, Philosophy, Politics, and Economics (PPE)

AGENDA

I study how authoritarian regimes emerge, persist, and both shape and respond to their societies, with a focus on the legacies of conflict and the long-run political foundations of inequality.

BOOK PROJECT

Action and Inheritance: Mobilizational Paths to Revolutionary Transformation.
In progress.

WORKING PAPERS

The Pull of the Center: The Mobilizational Roots of Transformation in Social Revolution. 2025. *Revise & Resubmit at World Politics*.

Ties that Rebind: Kinship Networks and Long-Run Postwar Integration. 2026.

The Democratic Externalities of Programmatic Incumbency: Evidence from Thailand, with Napon Jatusripitak. 2026.

Economic Shocks, Sovereign Debt, and Authoritarian Institutions in the Third Wave. 2025.

ARTICLES

Education for Control and Liberation in Africa and Among the Black Diaspora, with Guilherme Lambais, Dozie Okoye, and Leonard Wantchekon. 2023. *Comparative Education Review*, 67 (4): 861-883.

Fishing Rights and Colonial Government: Institutional Development in the Bengal Presidency, with Richard Adelstein. 2021. *Cambridge Journal of Economics* (45): 313-331.

BOOK CHAPTERS

The Art of Conquering Without Being Right: Agency, Education, and Learning by Doing in Cheikh Hamidou Kane's *Ambiguous Adventure*, with Paul-Aarons Ngomo and Leonard Wantchekon. 2025. In *Economics and Literature* eds. François Bourguignon, Avinash K. Dixit, Luc Leruth, and Jean-Philippe Platteau. London: Routledge.

Work in Progress

Who Stays in Opposition? with Somchai Phatharathananunth. 2026.

Anti-colonial Conflict and National Identity Formation in Southeast Asia, with Carles Boix. 2026.

Colonial Military Recruitment and Nationalist Mobilization: Evidence from Algeria and the Raj, with Hani Abdel-Warith. 2026.

Three Networks in a Zomian Revolution (qualitative companion to "The Pull of the Center"). 2025.

Awards and Honors

Harold W. Dodds Honorific Fellowship, Princeton University 2025-2026

- Competitive fellowship that "recognizes exceptional students in their later years of study" across Princeton University

Best paper by junior scholar, APSA Southeast Asia Related Group (SEAPRG) 2025
Southeast Asia Research Group (SEAREG), Fellow Winter 2024

Research Grants

The Institute for Humane Studies, 3,000 USD 2026
Data Driven Social Science (DDSS), Princeton University, 10,000 USD 2025-2026
The Mamdouha S. Bobst Center for Peace and Justice, Princeton University, for pre-dissertation and dissertation fieldwork, 13,500 USD 2022-2024
Princeton Institute for International and Regional Studies, for pre-dissertation and dissertation fieldwork, 13,400 USD 2022-2025
Davenport Grant, Wesleyan University, for undergraduate thesis fieldwork 2013

Presentations

Democratic Regression and Resilience in East and Southeast Asia, Chulalongkorn University, Bangkok (non-presenting co-author) 2026 (scheduled)
Conference on Agency in Institutional and Human Capital Development, Princeton University (co- with African School of Economics) 2026
APSA 2024, 2025, 2026
MPSA 2026
Singapore Management University 2026
Southeast Asia Research Group (SEAREG), Boston University 2024
Harvard-Yale Southeast Asia Graduate Conference, Harvard University 2024
Princeton University, Comparative Politics Seminar 2022-2025

Teaching

Intro to Quantitative Social Science (undergraduate), Assistant Instructor Fall 2024
Comparative Politics (undergraduate), Assistant Instructor Spring 2023
Junior Independent Plenary (undergraduate), Assistant Instructor Fall 2022
American Center @ That Dam, Vientiane, Laos, Full-time Instructor 2017-2019
Wesleyan University Writing Center, Writing Tutor 2012-2013

Research Fieldwork

Created new survey infrastructure. Original data collection through community partnerships: surveys, genealogies, and oral histories.

Laos, Vientiane and rural areas in northern Laos 2022-2026 (total 9 months)
Thailand, Bangkok and Isan 2022-2026 (total 9 months)
Vietnam, Hanoi 2022 (3 weeks)

Professional Experience

Office of American Spaces, US Department of State, Hanoi, Vietnam 2019-2020
Consultant, Impact Assessment and Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E)

- Designed and implemented surveys, conducted 40+ interviews and multiple focus groups, created impact evaluation and M&E framework for US embassy educational and civic programming in Laos and Vietnam. Conducted first ever impact analysis of American Spaces.

Fulbright Program, Vientiane, Laos 2017-2019
Fulbright Fellow

- Developed syllabi for classes in English, social studies, and professional skills for university students and young professionals and taught full time at the American Center, Vientiane. Helped plan orientation and structure Fulbright program in Laos.

The Northstar Group, Inc., New York, NY 2015-2017
Investment Associate

- Researched investments and helped make portfolio allocation decisions at growing investment advisory. Developed and programmed Monte Carlo simulations to forecast portfolio performance.

Languages

Lao [fluent speaking & reading], Thai [intermediate speaking & reading], Bengali [fluent speaking, intermediate reading], Hindi [fluent speaking, intermediate reading], Spanish [intermediate speaking & reading], Khmu [beginner, no written script]

Software

R, Stata, Python, MatLab, LaTeX

References

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September 23, 2026